NOTICE 1
23 October 2012

TEST OPERATIONS PROCEDURE

This Test Operations Procedure (TOP) has been archived per ATEC memorandum dated 18 October 2012.

Requests shall be referred to Headquarters, U.S. Army Test and Evaluation Command, 2202 Aberdeen Boulevard, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5055, usarmy.APG.atec.mbx.atec-standards@mail.mil

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13. ABSTRACT

Provides guidance for testing of trailers, semitrailers, and dollies to assure conformance with Required Operational Capabilities, Development Plans, and other guidance documents. By reference to official documents describes subtests involved in preparation of test plan. Includes supplementary instructions on test planning, initial inspection and servicing, vehicle characteristics, safety evaluation, endurance, durability, and reliability.

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DEVELOPMENT TEST II (ET) - SYSTEM TEST OPERATIONS PROCEDURES

AMSTE-RP-702-101
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TRAILERS, SEMITRAILERS, AND DOLLIES

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SECTION I
GENERAL

1. Purpose and Scope. This TOP provides guidance for planning tests of trailers, semitrailers, and dollies to assure their conformance with Required Operational Capabilities (ROC's), Development Plans (DP's), and other guidance documents. Appropriate subtests suitable to meet the requirements of development tests I, II or III or other customer sponsored tests can be selected from those listed in section II.

2. Background.

a. Trailers and Semitrailers. Trailers and semitrailers are nonpowered vehicles designed primarily to transport supplies and equipment. They range in capacity from 1/4-ton to 55 tons.

(1) A trailer is a nonpowered wheeled or tracked vehicle with all or most of its weight supported by its own wheels or tracks. It is designed to be towed by a self-propelled motor vehicle. Typical trailers are used to haul ammunition, cargo, or electrical equipment. They can be

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readily attached to a prime mover for transporting to a different location. The trailer is connected to the prime mover by the pintle hook.

(2) A semitrailer is a nonpowered vehicle designed so that a large part of its weight is supported by its connection to the towing vehicle (fifth wheel), the remainder being supported by the rear wheels of the semitrailer. An integral part of the semitrailer is the retractable landing gear which supports the front of the trailer when it is not connected to the prime mover. Some models, instead of having landing gear, are of the folding gooseneck type in which the kickup portion of the semitrailer folds down to permit vehicles to be driven on and off the semitrailer. Typical semitrailers include gasoline tankers, communications vans, and tank transporters.

b. Dollies. Dollies are nonpowered vehicles used for converting a wide range of Army semitrailers, shelters, or other transportable housings to trailers suitable for towing. Dollies are usually available in two- and four-wheeled configurations. Certain two-wheeled types are capable of supporting nominal payloads of 4 tons and, typically, are used in pairs to convert a stationary nonvehicle, such as a shelter, to a trailer. Other two- and four-wheeled dolly configurations are available in payload capacities extending nominally to 15 tons for those missions that require conversion of a wide range of Army semitrailers to trailers suitable for towing by prime movers other than the conventional tractor vehicle.

(1) Methods of connecting dollies to semitrailers, shelters, or other forms of transportable housings vary with the mission and configuration of the vehicle involved. Two principal coupling systems are common: (a) the "fifth wheel" for dollies used to convert semitrailers to trailers and (b) the rigid cradle frame semipermanently bolted or clamped in place for converting a transportable shelter or housing to a trailer. Once a given dolly is connected to a semitrailer or transportable shelter, the resulting trailer configuration is attached to the prime mover's pintle by the dolly lunette and variations of the conventional hinged drawbar. In all cases, dollies are also connected to the applicable prime mover by flexible intervehicular hoses and cables providing brake system air pressure or hydraulic pressure, electrical power, and applicable control commands. In addition, safety chains provide a measure of protection should the primary lunette-pintle connection fail or malfunction.

(2) Dollies, with accessories and special equipment, are required to support specified payloads and be capable of operating on all types of hard-surfaced and unimproved roads and open, rolling, and hilly terrain for extended periods of time under varying and often extreme environmental conditions. When without actual payloads, simulated loads must be installed for test purposes in accordance with the load diagram furnished by the requesting agency.

3. Equipment and Facilities. Equipment and facilities are covered in the references in section II.

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SECTION II
TEST PROCEDURES

4. Supporting Tests. Subtests to be considered in formulating a development test plan, with TOP/MTP and other references, are listed below. The list is generally in a preferred order of completion; factors to consider are discussed in paragraph 5c.

TEST SUBJECT TITLE	PUBLICATION NO.
a. Preparation for Test (refer to para 5)	
b. Testing.	
Initial Inspection (refer to para 6)	2-2-502
Stowage	2-2-802
Vehicle Characteristics (refer to para 7)	2-2-500
Preliminary Operation	2-2-505
Safety Evaluation (refer to para 8)	2-2-508
Braking, Tracked Vehicles	2-2-627
Braking, Wheeled Vehicles	2-2-608
Center of Gravity	2-2-800
Toxic Hazards	2-2-614
Winches	2-2-712
Standard Obstacles	2-2-611
Electromagnetic Interference (Noncommunications Equipment)	2-2-613
Electromagnetic Emissions (Electronic Equipment)	6-2-542
High and Low Temperatures	a2-2-816
Rain and Freezing Rain	2-2-815
Load Distribution and Ground Pressure	2-2-801
Fuels and Lubricants	2-2-701
Tires	2-2-704
Tracks	2-2-705
Tracked Vehicle Suspension Systems	2-2-714
Noise	3-2-811
Soft Soil Vehicle Mobility (Prepared Sites)	2-2-619
Off-Road Mobility (Natural Sites)	As determined by ROC, DP, test directive, and available terrain.
Field Shock and Vibration	2-2-808
Security from Detection (Vehicles)	2-2-615
Infrared Emissions from Vehicles	2-2-812
Communication Equipment (Vehicle)	2-2-709
Air Conditioners	10-2-145
Vehicle Heaters - Personnel	2-2-708
Solar Radiation	4-2-826

[a]When published.

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TEST SUBJECT TITLE	PUBLICATION NO.
High Humidity	4-2-820
Fungus Resistance	4-2-818
Salt Water and Salt-Laden Air	[a]1-2-604
Logistics-Over-The-Shore (LOTS)	2-2-520
Transportability	1-2-500
Cargo Loading Adaptability	2-2-537
Radioactive Components	3-2-711
Air Transportability	2-2-512
Vehicle Collision and Accident	2-2-621
Endurance Testing of Wheeled Vehicles	2-2-506
Endurance and Reliability (refer to para 9)	2-2-507, [b]2-1-001
Durability (refer to para 9)	1-2-502, [b]2-1-001
Human Factors Engineering	2-2-803
Maintenance Evaluation	[a]1-2-501, TECR 750-15
Value Engineering	In accordance with current directives
Overload Testing (Vehicle)	2-2-626
Electrical Power Measurements for Vehicle Subsystems	[b]2-2-601
Gradeability and Side Slope Mobility	2-2-610
Fording	2-2-612

[a]When published.
[b]When revised.

SECTION III
SUPPLEMENTARY INSTRUCTIONS

5. Preparation for Test

a. Review of Test Guidance.

(1) The subtests that are selected by the test agency are governed by requirements in the ROC's, DP's, other guidance documents, and by test directives from supervising agencies. The levels of acceptable performance are usually stipulated. If adequate test guidance does not exist, the test plan writer will make appropriate inquiries to the responsible directorate at TECOM.

(2) Certain important characteristics, especially those involving advanced engineering technology, may not be specifically covered by the requirements document but should nevertheless be included in the test plan and evaluated as a part of development test I, II, or III, per AR 1000-1. These may include such features as infrared emissions, shielding against fallout radiation, decontamination of CBR agents, noise measurements, transient voltages, and electromagnetic interference and emissions.

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b. Safe Operations During Testing. All hazardous test operations must be covered by a standing operating procedure (SOP) that will provide compulsory safety measures to be followed (e.g., as required by APG Regulation 385-1 at Aberdeen Proving Ground). Some typical operations that are categorized as hazardous are: amphibious operations, carrying bulk quantities of fuel, longitudinal and side slope operation, operation in inclosed chambers (such as cold rooms), and transportation of explosives. Safety measures for routine operations are prescribed in local safety manuals. Lesser routine hazards are covered by internal operating procedures. If a hazardous test is contemplated, the test director should assure that a suitable SOP covers the testing. If none is available, he must write one and obtain approval for its use..

c. Sequence and Selection of Subtests. Of primary consideration in the sequencing of subtests is the need, in the early months of testing, to thoroughly investigate the "critical issues" listed in the Coordinated Test Plan (CTP) in time for the decision meeting. Otherwise the actual sequencing of subtests should consider performing the high-risk, short-duration tests early and the low-risk, long-duration tests later in the test period. When required by a TECOM directive, a formalized assessment of the risk associated with each subtest will be made in accordance with TECR 70-34. The high-risk subtests are those in which a failure may lead to early termination of the vehicle test or justify an early judgment on critical performance parameters.

(1) Such items as stowage compartments, cold weather kits, maintenance test packages, heaters, and air conditioners can be utilized and at least partially tested while the vehicle is undergoing endurance testing. Certain tests, such as those involving vulnerability and accident safety, should be scheduled late in the test program because of the possibility of damaging the vehicle. The type of test, availability of certain kits and similar equipment, and the nature of the possible effect of the test phase on the vehicle or equipment being tested are also factors. A safety evaluation, for instance, would be conducted immediately after the initial inspections and preliminary operation so that the safety aspects could be disseminated to interested agencies. Performance tests covering (e.g.) standard obstacles and mobility should be conducted prior to or at intermediate endurance testing mileages. It is desirable to obtain the performance data before the chassis is subjected to the rigors of extensive endurance testing. Comparisons of the performance of various vehicles over a number of years will thus be more valid since all will have been tested in generally the same physical condition.

(2) To test and evaluate trailers, semitrailers, and dollies a number of subtests apply. The selection of appropriate tests is dependent upon the type of test (e.g., development test I), the availability of test resources (e.g., number of vehicles, funding, test facilities), the time available for the test, the special characteristics

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of the vehicle, and the desires of the agency overseeing the test program. The possible test phases that may be included in test plans are listed in paragraph 4; rarely will a vehicle be subjected to all. Certain phases of the development tests may require participation by the Boards just as in the past some engineering test phases were combined with the service test when directed by Headquarters, TECOM.

d. Sample Size. The test sample size is usually determined far in advance of testing by the number of vehicles on a production contract, the funds available for testing, or the nature of the test. When the test director has an input regarding the sample size, he should use available mathematical procedures, taking cognizance of stipulated confidence and reliability levels as explained in paragraph 9. Miles that each vehicle must travel are determined simultaneously with sample size.

e. Familiarization and Training. When a vehicle introduces new features, it may be necessary to train operators, maintenance personnel, and the test director. Such training will normally be given by TACOM or a contractor, and should be arranged at an early date.

6. Initial Inspection and Servicing.

a. An initial inspection is conducted to assure that the test items are in good condition and that major component serial numbers and other pretest data are recorded prior to initiation of the test program. These include:

(1) Serial numbers and other identification of vehicle and major components.

(2) Examination of maintenance test package for completeness.

(3) Spring deflection at curb weight and with highway payload.

(4) Tire tread depth.

(5) On-equipment materiel (OEM) stowage (per TOP/MTP 2-2-802).

b. The vehicle is drained of all fluids and is completely serviced by lubricating and filling with standard lubricants and fluids. The identification and quantity of all fluids used are recorded, and attention is called to unusual quantities. If drain or fill times are unreasonably long, these should be noted together with information on influencing factors such as size of drain plugs.

7. Vehicle Characteristics. Vehicle characteristics including physical dimensions are recorded in accordance with TOP/MTP 2-2-500. A characteristics photograph is taken, and a tabulation of important features is assembled also in accordance with TOP/MTP 2-2-500.

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8. Safety Evaluation. An interim safety release should be generated within 60 days of test initiation. The interim safety release recommendation is given based on subtests performed early in the test. The subtests include, but are not limited to, preliminary operation, braking, steering, center of gravity, gradeability, side slopes, toxic hazards, winches, speed, obstacles, and night operations. The safety evaluation does not end with the issuance of the safety release: it is considered to be a continuing subtest throughout the test program and, when required, will include vehicle collision and accident safety.

9. Endurance, Durability, and Reliability.

a. Endurance is a general term that is concerned with the ability of a vehicle to perform satisfactorily under typical field conditions for long periods of time. Endurance tests of tracked vehicles are covered in TOP/MTP 2-2-507 which prescribes test courses and number of miles unless otherwise prescribed by the directive or guidance document.

b. Durability is a precise term that relates to the mathematical probability that a vehicle will be able to operate under typical field conditions for a specified number of miles before requiring major overhaul. Since durability tests require many samples and considerable funding, they are seldom conducted; the endurance test, which is much more limited, is usually conducted instead. TOP 1-2-502 describes a durability test and provides guidance for selecting sample sizes and distances.

c. Reliability is defined as the probability that an item will perform its intended function for a specified time under specified conditions (i.e., the probability of successfully completing a mission without incurring a mission-aborting failure). The reliability requirement is usually expressed as a probability of success for one or more specified operational and environmental cycles or functional sequences (mission). This requirement may be expressed in several ways; e.g., as an acceptable mean-time-between-failure (MTBF). In the MTBF context "T" may be expressed as hours, cycles, rounds, miles, etc. Most of the data for the reliability determination are obtained from the endurance test, which simultaneously provides data for the maintenance evaluation.

d. The matter of endurance, durability, and reliability will be more fully covered in TOP/MTP 2-1-001 when revised.

Recommended changes to this publication should be forwarded to Commander, U. S. Army Test and Evaluation Command, ATTN: AMSTE-ME, Aberdeen Proving Ground, Md. 21005. Technical information may be obtained from the preparing activity: Commander, Aberdeen Proving Ground, ATTN: STEAP-MT-M, Aberdeen Proving Ground, Md. 21005. Additional copies are available from the Defense Documentation Center, Cameron Station, Alexandria, Va. 22314. This document is identified by the accession number (AD No.) printed on the first page.

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APPENDIX
REFERENCES

1. AR 70-38, "Research, Development, Test, and Evaluation of Materiel for Extreme Climatic Conditions."

2. AR 705-25, "Reliability Program for Materiel and Equipment."

3. AR 1000-1, "Basic Policies for Systems Acquisition by the Department of the Army."

4. AMC Supplement 1 to AR 70-10, "Test and Evaluation During Research and Development of Materiel."

5. AMC Supplement 1 to AR 705-50, "Army Materiel Reliability and Maintainability."

6. AMCR 385-12, "Life Cycle Verification of Materiel Safety."

7. AMCP 702-3, "Reliability Handbook."

8. AMCP 706-134, "Maintainability Guide for Design."

9. TECR 70-23, "Equipment Performance Reports."

10. TECR 70-34, "Risk Analysis for Suitability Tests."

11. TECR 385-6, "Verification of Safety of Materiel During Testing."

12. TECR 750-15, "Maintenance Evaluation During Testing."

13. MIL-STD-721B, "Definition of Terms for Reliability Engineering, Human Factors, and Safety."

14. Bekker, M. G., "Introduction to Terrain Vehicle Systems," The University of Michigan Press, Ann Arbor, Michigan.

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